

How Big Should an Area Rug Be?

To get all the room-boosting benefits of an [area rug](#), you need to first choose the right size. A [dining room rug](#) should be large enough to accommodate all chair legs even when they're pushed away from the table. [Dining chairs](#) are moved in and out frequently, and it's safest if they're always on a flat surface. An area rug should extend at least 24 inches beyond the sides of your [dining table](#), with more space for larger dining chairs.

In the [living room](#), the front legs of all [sofas](#) and [chairs](#) should be placed on your [area rug](#). If your [seating area](#) measures between rug sizes, it's usually best to size up. When you have a smaller seating area or a very large rug, you can also arrange furniture so that all legs are on the area rug. What happens if you buy a smaller rug that doesn't extend underneath living room seating? Instead of tying the furniture together, a too-small rug can make your [living room](#) look disjointed.

The most popular way to style a [bedroom](#) rug is horizontally, with the [bed's](#) bottom legs placed over the rug. Shop for a rug in the 8×10 size range to get this look with a [queen size bed](#). If you want an [area rug](#) positioned underneath the entire bed, it should be wide enough to also fit accompanying [nightstands](#).

Natural or Synthetic?

The right materials are determined by your lifestyle and how you'll use an [area rug](#). Natural materials, synthetics and blends of the two all offer different advantages. If you're looking for an [area rug](#) that will last for decades, wool is an excellent choice. Wool options like our [Victor Rug](#) hold their shape for long periods of time and provide natural warmth. [Area rugs](#) made from synthetic materials are stain resistant, easy to clean and economical, making them great options for families with pets or kids. If you're looking for a synthetic that replicates the look of natural wool, our [Mcgowan Rug in Light Grey](#) offers soft, varied tones to make your [living room](#) extra cozy.

Art for Your Floor

How do you want your room to look? [Area rugs](#) are an easy way to add pattern, texture and colour. A vibrant rug can have the same impact as a piece of art. This is your chance to introduce visual appeal without taking up precious floor space.

Our newest rugs are statement-making pieces that can completely transform your room. Featuring cool blues and sun-kissed highlights, our colourful [Clairmont Rug](#) is the perfect starting point for a refreshed living room. If you prefer vintage vibes, the [Samya Rug](#) brings patterned style with contemporary greys and multi-coloured highlights. Cultivating a more modern look?

Choose a stylish piece like our [Engel Rug](#) to add texture and colour without overpowering the room.



Affordable Area Rugs and How to Find the Right Rug For Your Bedroom



[Emily Henderson](#)

You've probably heard that one of the most common design mistakes is having the wrong size area rug. I know the story all too well – you found one you liked but the bigger version was a bit outside the budget, so you opted for the smaller size. Been there!! The thing is though that your rug is the foundation of your room and it brings everything together through one grounding point. You don't want it to be a small accent piece just floating there but the anchor to the entire

space. Not to mention that it really sets the tone and style of the room. I actually like to start most designs with the area rug and then build from there!

If you've been following [my stories](#), you know that I'm updating some elements in our master bedroom. I have a 6' x 9' area rug that I love at the foot of the bed, but now that we upgraded to our king, it definitely feels too small. I've started to consider swapping it out, even though I do still love it! And so, because I've been browsing, I thought now would be a great time to share some amazingly affordable area rugs and divulge a few tips when it comes to choosing a rug for a bedroom. Let's jump in...

1. **The Right Size Matters:** Ideally you want the rug to have around 24" on all three sides of the bed. But this doesn't have to be a hard rule in every situation. If you have a smaller bedroom like I do, getting the front legs of the bed frame on the rug will help to anchor the space. You can also float a smaller rug in front of the bed or have 2' x 3' rugs flanking either side. My 6' x 9' rug looked fine under our queen but ideally an 8' x 10' or even 9' x 12' would be best.
2. **Search Smart:** What I sometimes do is go on to direct rug brands like [Savafieh](#) or [Loloi Rugs](#), or more curated sites like [Lulu & Georgia](#). Once I find a rug I like, I google the name of it or do an image search and try to find it at another retailer for less.
3. **Find Favourites:** Besides crossing your fingers walking into Home Sense, I have a few go to's for affordable area rugs. I find that [Urban Outfitters](#) has some amazing options (not as many bigger sizes though), [Rugs USA](#) delivers to Canada, as well as [Wayfair](#) and [Overstock](#). I've even seen some good options on [Amazon](#). Then, you can catch some great sales at [West Elm](#) and [CB2](#) and nab a great deal! Of course if you're lucky enough to live in the states and can grab a Target area rug, then lucky you!



[Amber Interiors](#)

So, with those tips, here are some really great options that are both beautiful and affordable (3 of which are in my own house too!)

AFFORDABLE AREA RUGS UNDER \$300

Decor Round Up

/1/



/2/



/3/



/4/



/5/



/6/



/7/



/8/



/9/



In both our
bedrooms

/10/



What do you think? See any favourites? #3 has been in Jack's room for over a year now and it's holding up really well. Definitely a favourite! #9 is our current master bedroom rug and I love it because it hides the dog fur remarkably well and I love the mix of colours. And #10 was in our guest bedroom but I moved it into our living room just for now...It's great for a busy family because the darker tones disguise stains well, but it also looks more expensive than it actually is!

Stay tuned for more on our master bedroom revamp shortly! I can't wait to share it with you! (Oh and if you haven't seen our master bedroom before, check it out [here!](#))

Do I Need An Area Rug?



[Sasha Spencer](#)

Share:



Area rugs can really bring an entire look together and create cohesion in your space. You know that an area rug is a nice thing to have, sure, but ... do you really *need* it?

You might even be looking at your space thinking: “You know what? It looks just fine without a rug!” And you may be right, but if you have that nagging feeling that your room is incomplete, perhaps an area rug is exactly what you need.

At McElheran’s Furniture + Design, we offer a wide selection of area rugs to fit any space. In fact, we have an entire rug centre! Should you feel the need to browse (and even take a sample home to try it out), that rug centre is all yours, but if you don’t want one, hey, that’s fine, too.

Perhaps at this point, you just want to know what an area rug actually does for your space. Does it just look nice, or will it serve some sort of critical function that you should know about?

In this article, one of our [Design Guides](#) (AKA area rug guru), [Shelley](#), will answer that burning question of “do I need an area rug?” and the benefits of having one. We’ll even discuss the benefits of *not* having an area rug – because you might be leaning in that direction anyway - and there’s nothing wrong with that!

And if your space already has wall-to-wall carpet, that’s a whole different ball game, isn’t it? We’ll chat about whether you need an area rug in that kind of room, too!

Do I actually need an area rug?

Not exactly, **no**.

You can certainly survive without an area rug, but from a design standpoint, an area rug can do a lot for your space. It’s at least worth looking into and weighing your options, anyway.

The benefits of an area rug

In addition to being a beautiful piece that can really pull an entire room together aesthetically, an area rug serves many practical functions, too.



Defines a space

Particularly if your home has an open layout, an area rug can help to distinguish different zones. An area rug gives your room an anchor; something to position your furniture around. It allows you to create your own space to suit your needs, instead of relying on the architecture of the room.

Provides warmth

Area rugs add warmth – literally and metaphorically! If your home is filled with tile or non-carpeted flooring, a rug can protect your feet from the chilly floors. Visually, it can also take your space from feeling cold and vacant to cozy and inviting.

Noise reduction

Area rugs help absorb sound in your home, so it's not as loud. Actually, all of your soft furnishings (sofas and other seating) help to reduce echo and noise in your home.

Also, walking on an area rug is much quieter than on a hard, uncovered floor.

Reduces impact

Just like an area rug reduces the sound of footsteps, it can also lessen the impact a hard surface has on your body. Walking around on a hard surface all day can be tough on your feet and back, and an area rug can lighten the load on your joints.

Gives a starting point for space planning

Area rugs can be the perfect starting point if you're re-furnishing and decorating an entire room. Shelley loves to start with an appropriately sized area rug and then space plan around it. Even if the rug is removed from the final plan, it's a good way to get the ball rolling to determine the layout of a room.

Introduces more design

If you're looking for more ways to express your personal style in your space, an area rug gives you another avenue for just that. Add more interest, pattern, colour, and texture with an area rug.

You can think of an area rug more like a piece of art, as opposed to just a mat to lay your furniture on top of.

The benefits of not having an area rug



We've had clients in the past forgo an area rug. Everyone's entitled to that, and there are certainly benefits to going without an area rug. It's really about the look you're going for with the room and how you want it to feel when you're in it.

Saves money

Leaving an area rug out of your space saves you money because, well, you're not buying another piece for your home. And if you eventually want an area rug, but it just doesn't seem to be in the cards right now, you can always wait!

Lower maintenance

Area rugs are actually not too labour-intensive to take care of, but they do require some upkeep. And when it comes to spills, it's generally easier to quickly wipe something off a non-carpeted floor than an area rug.

Area rugs do tend to collect dust and trap dander, too. Some pet owners like to skip the area rug to prevent pet hair from building up.

Related Article: [Area Rug Care Tips: How to Look After the Rugs in Your Home](#)

Less of a tripping hazard

With small children or seniors, it's important to make your living space as safe and easy to navigate as possible. If the pile (thickness) of your area rug is quite high, it may be too cumbersome and almost more of a hazard for someone's mobility.

That's not to say that area rugs are dangerous – far from it, in fact! But, depending on who's using your space, opting out of an area rug may be a safer option.

Allows your flooring to shine

If you have an intricately tiled area or want to show off the details of your flooring, you might want to avoid covering things up with an area rug. Sometimes the original construction and architecture of your home are all you need to create a space you love.

Less restrictive

Really, a key feature of an area rug is that it distinguishes a space, but perhaps you don't need that. You may find that an area rug takes away from the flow of your room. Particularly if it's ill-fitting, forcing an area rug into your space may end up restricting your design.

Can I layer an area rug over carpet?

Contrary to popular belief, **you can definitely put an area rug over a carpeted area.** Especially if your carpet is pretty neutral and leaves a lot to be desired from a design standpoint. Layering on an area rug is a great way to add an artistic element and introduce more texture and colour into your space.

And again, area rugs instantly create zones in your home. So, if you're in need of something to distinguish one area from another – a rug is a great way to go. Yes, even if the room is already carpeted.

At McElheran's, we've actually done this for quite a few clients, and it can make an amazing difference!

What size of area rug do I need?

If you're feeling like yes, an area rug is necessary, just keep in mind that size plays a major role in whether it will work in your space or not. Check out "[What Size Should My Area Rug Be In My Living Room?](#)" to make sure you get it right – the first time!

We've mentioned a few times here that an area rug can really help in the overall layout and plan of a space – but it's not a requirement, right? So, if you'd still like to make a space plan, but don't think you need an area rug, we can help with that during an in-home consultation! Here's [how to prepare](#) for one, so you get the most out of your appointment.

And if you're in Edmonton, you can always [drop by the showroom](#). Our Design Guides will be happy to direct you to our rug centre. And if you see something you think you like, you can actually take samples home with you at no obligation (just bring them back when you're done, please!)

The US area rugs market is valued at approximately \$3.15 billion in 2024 and is projected to grow at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 5% to reach over \$4.14 billion by 2030. Key drivers include consumer demand for personalized interior design, while challenges include the impact of tariffs on sales volume and price sensitivity, particularly in the mid- to lower-end market segments. Wool was the largest material segment in 2024, but nylon is the fastest-growing material.

Market size and growth

- **2024 Market Size:** Approximately \$3,154.1 million.
- **2030 Projected Market Size:** Approximately \$4,141.4 million.
- **Growth Rate:** Expected to grow at a CAGR of 5% from 2025 to 2030.
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Key trends and drivers

- **Interior Design:** A major driver is the increasing consumer preference for personalized and unique interior designs.
- **Product Innovation:** Companies are focusing on product innovations like machine-washable and performance rugs to meet modern living needs.
- **Material Trends:** While wool was the largest segment in 2024, nylon is the fastest-growing material. Synthetic fibers like polyester and polypropylene are also dominant.
- **Market Segments:** The household segment accounts for about 60% of the market. However, the middle-to-lower end of the market is currently struggling, while the high-end market remains stable.
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Challenges

- **Tariffs:** Tariffs have negatively impacted sales volume and customer demand, leading to more hesitant buying behaviors.
- **Price Sensitivity:** Consumers are more price-sensitive, which is particularly affecting the lower to middle-price tiers.
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Opportunities

- **Targeted Marketing:** Companies can increase visibility and drive sales through collaborations with interior designers and influencers.
- **Product Diversification:** Focusing on innovative solutions, such as machine-washable or custom-made rugs, can capture market opportunities.
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Leading players

- Some key market players include Mohawk Industries Inc, Milliken & Company, and [The Dixie Group Inc.](#)
- [Shaw Industries Group, Inc.](#) holds the largest market share in the US carpet mills industry.